

The 6:15

TUESDAY · SEPTEMBER 8, 2026

NO. 12

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · NEXT 10 DAYS

Tue 9/8 (today)	Canada's counter-tariffs on C\$27.6B of U.S. imports take effect, 12:01a ET — steel/aluminum, pulp/paper, dairy, electronics, furniture, apparel across 600+ classifications.
Thu 9/10	Adobe (ADBE) reports fiscal Q3 after close. Cons. adj. EPS \$6.09 on ~\$6.7B rev. — near the top of Adobe's own guidance. [weekday corrected — prior issues said "Wed"]
Fri 9/11	Aug. CPI, 8:30a (BLS) — cons. headline +0.2% m/m/3.4% y/y, core +0.1-0.2%/2.5%. Last data point before the Fed meets. [weekday corrected — prior issues said "Thu"]
Sat 9/12	Northwestern on a bye.
Mon 9/14	Oracle (ORCL) reports after close.
Tue-Wed 9/15-16	FOMC decision/SEP Wed 2p, presser 2:30p. Hike-to-3.75-4.00% odds 58.4% (Investing.com Fed Rate Monitor, 5:55a ET) [60-66% quoted elsewhere late last week, unreconciled]
Sat 9/19	Northwestern hosts Colorado, 6:30p CT.

No verified rocket launch or VC round of comparable scale to Nvidia-Hugging Face fell inside this run's 24-48h window or the 10-day forward calendar; sub-bullet skipped.

METRICS · AS OF ~6:20A ET TUE 9/8 UNLESS NOTED

Brent / WTI	\$97.24-99.16 intraday, last ~\$98.7 (7-wk high); WTI \$92.37-94.46 — no settle yet, either ; Goldman raised Dec. Brent/WTI forecasts to \$85/\$80 on the news
2Y / 10Y / 30Y	10Y 4.79-4.81% (near 3-yr highs); 2Y 4.38%; 30Y 5.27%
DXY / VIX	DXY 98.84-99.21, opened 99.17; VIX cash no clean Fri close located — traded <14 midday Fri (StoneX); Sept. VIX futures 16.2-16.3

Futures	Dow/S&P/Nasdaq pointed lower premarket on the oil spike (AP) — no clean point-level print located
S&P / Dow / Nasdaq	7,718.60 (-0.38%) / 53,414.25 (-0.51%) / 26,506.99 (-0.29%) — last close, Fri 9/4 (Mon 9/7 holiday)
Asia & Europe	Nikkei 65,269.33 (-1.7%, yen strength, reversing Mon's +2.1%); Kospi 6,954.52 (-0.6%); Hang Seng 25,345.04 (-0.3%) — Tue close. Stoxx 600 -0.04%, DAX -0.25%, FTSE 100 -0.1%, CAC 40 +0.33%, FTSE MIB +0.25% — Mon 9/7 close
Gold / retail gas	\$4,431-4,435/oz spot, down from \$4,476.60 Sat 9/5; gas \$4.15/gal natl. avg (AAA, 9/4) [stale]

Both Brent and WTI moving on the Houthis strike on Saudi energy facilities (see Lead). Nikkei's reversal is yen-driven; Kospi/Hang Seng softer on broader Mideast risk-off.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure	Day 191 (straits.live, since Feb. 28 declaration, as of 08 SEP 1017Z)
Transits	6 vessels Aug. 30 (PortWatch, stale) vs. straits.live's 85/day baseline (~7% of normal); CBS/Reuters separately cite a ~130/day pre-war baseline — unreconciled
Dark tankers	54 of 185 screened (29.2%) dark in last 24h vs. 7-day baseline of 74.0 (straits.live) — a different read from the >80%-of-traffic figure in recent issues; window shift, not a verified improvement
War-risk premia	~\$10.0M/VLCC passage, ~40x pre-crisis (straits.live) — unchanged order of magnitude
Strikes (24h)	Houthi drone/missile attack on Saudi Aramco's Jazan-area facilities (see Lead) — Saudi soil, distinct from the strait strike count, not refreshed this run

PortWatch (AIS-broadcast crossings only), straits.live/Kpler dark-fleet reads and war-risk quotes measure different things over different windows — never netted or averaged. Private Gulf war-risk cover has been unavailable since March; the ~\$10M/VLCC quote reflects the ~\$20B US DFC reinsurance backstop, not a return of private capacity.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	off Monday (travel from San Diego); open a 3-game home series vs. the Rockies tonight, 7:05p ET. 81-61, 3.5 back of Tampa Bay (84-57); hold the top AL wild card
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Knicks	Josh Hart extension still unsigned; no new terms since 9/3 (4-yr/\$132M max eligible vs. a 3-yr/\$54-62M deal seen as more likely)
Northwestern	on a bye at 1-0, coming off the 34-18 win over South Dakota State

LEAD

SECOND FRONT, SAME STRAIT

Houthi strike Saudi Aramco's southern facilities, wounding 73 and pushing Brent to a seven-week high, as Iran moves in parallel to declare a Hormuz "exclusion zone"

Houthi forces fired drones and ballistic missiles at Saudi energy facilities in the kingdom's south early Tuesday, wounding at least 73 people and forcing operators to halt some operations, Saudi authorities said. The Saudi-led coalition reported strikes and resulting fires across Abha, Khamis Mushait, Jazan and Najran, with the heaviest damage concentrated at Aramco installations in the Jazan area; Royal Saudi Air Force spokesman Col. Turki al-Malki pledged the coalition would "take all necessary operational measures to deter this terrorist militia," while a Houthi deputy media chief said a statement on a "large-scale military operation" inside Saudi Arabia was forthcoming. Brent crude jumped as much as 2.2% intraday to a seven-week high near \$99 a barrel before easing toward the high-\$97s by mid-morning Asia hours; WTI touched \$94.46 before pulling back toward the low \$90s. Goldman Sachs, reacting to the strike, raised its December 2026 Brent forecast by \$5 to \$85 and its WTI forecast to \$80, citing expected Middle East shipping disruptions extending into 2027.

The attack landed the same day Iran moved to formalize a second front in the Hormuz standoff. Maj. Gen. Mohsen Rezaei, secretary of Iran's Supreme National Security Council, posted Tuesday that Washington had "received a clear warning from Iran's new missiles" and that "economic warfare will be met by a maritime exclusion zone" running from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, with the "operational posture toward US warships and bases... fundamentally recalibrated." The zone, first previewed Monday, would let Iran warn off — or sanction-list — vessels approaching the strait without Iranian cooperation; the US State Department told Al Jazeera that Washington would take "decisive measures" against any attempt to restrict navigation and was coordinating with regional partners.

Mechanically, the two events are separate: a Yemen-based, Iran-aligned Houthi strike on Saudi soil, and a direct Iranian government policy shift inside the Gulf. But markets are pricing them as compounding, because both raise the odds that energy-supply disruption spreads beyond the strait itself rather than staying contained to the six-month-old tanker war. The Houthi strike hit processing and storage infrastructure, not export capacity directly — Saudi Arabia's playbook, used after the March 2026 Ras Tanura drone strike, is to reroute exports through the Red Sea port of Yanbu when eastern or southern facilities are compromised, which cushions the immediate physical-supply hit and is a likely reason Tuesday's spike retraced from its overnight highs by the time European trading opened. What doesn't retrace as easily is the war-risk calculus: a second active front layered on top of the Hormuz confrontation makes the "temporary spike, self-limiting conflict" framing markets have leaned on since February harder to sustain. It is that repricing

of persistence — not the barrel-for-barrel supply loss, which so far is modest — that is moving the curve and Goldman's forecast revision alike.

The more immediate second-order consequence lands on Thursday's — and Friday's — inflation math. Retail gasoline was already at \$4.15 a gallon nationally before this week's move, up from the low-\$3 range that prevailed before the Hormuz closure; a sustained push toward \$99 Brent widens the pass-through window into Friday's CPI print and, by extension, into the Sept. 15-16 FOMC decision. That print was already the pivot point the two sides of the Fed's internal hike debate were waiting on: Gov. Waller's dovish dissent is conditioned explicitly on continued disinflation, while a hawkish majority has been treating Friday's blowout jobs report as sufficient grounds on its own. An energy-driven CPI beat would hand the hawks a second, independent argument without needing core services prices to cooperate — precisely the scenario that would be hardest for Waller's framework to absorb. Equity futures reflected that read straight through the Asia session: the Nikkei fell 1.7% on a stronger yen and Mideast risk-off — a reversal of Monday's 2.1% gain — while the Kospi and Hang Seng each slipped and US index futures pointed lower into Tuesday's cash open, the first full-liquidity US session since Friday's jobs report and Saturday's Iran-US naval clash, now absorbing a third shock in four trading sessions. The insurance math underneath both stories is the same: private war-risk cover for the Gulf has been gone since March, replaced by the roughly \$20B US DFC reinsurance facility that keeps VLCC premia at a finite, quotable ~40x-normal rather than unavailable at any price — a backstop built for a Hormuz-only crisis that traders are

now, for the first time, pricing against a second, Saudi-soil front it was not explicitly designed to cover.

POLITICS

The 2026 general-election season formally opened over the long weekend, and early positioning favors Democrats: a national survey put the generic-ballot House race at 52%-46% Democratic, with polling averages now pointing to a Democratic House takeover as the likeliest outcome in November — a shift from the tighter numbers that held through the spring. Voters split sharply by issue: Republicans lead on border security (+15 points), national security (+12) and immigration (+5); Democrats lead on healthcare (+21), affordability (+14) and helping the middle class (+14). Trump's MAGA Inc. super PAC still plans to spend \$400-500M on midterm races. Structurally, Democrats need to flip a net of just three House seats and four Senate seats to take both chambers; Cook Political Report rates 17 House races true toss-ups, concentrated in Arizona, California, Pennsylvania and Washington, while Maine, North Carolina, Iowa and Texas are the Senate races analysts are watching most closely after late-summer primaries reshaped the map. No new movement was found this run on the Missouri redistricting ruling or the Postal Service mail-ballot injunction carried in the last issue.

ECONOMICS

Canada's dollar-for-dollar counter-tariffs on C\$27.6 billion of US imports — steel, aluminum, pulp and paper, dairy, electronics, industrial equipment, furniture, apparel and more, across 600-plus tariff classifications — took effect at 12:01a ET Tuesday, retaliation for US Section 338/232 duties on Canadian exports. Friday's CPI

print — not Thursday's, as carried in error across the last several issues, since Sept. 11, 2026 falls on a Friday — is now the last scheduled data point before the Fed meets Sept. 15-16; consensus sees headline CPI +0.2% m/m/3.4% y/y and core +0.1-0.2% m/m/2.5% y/y. Fed-hike odds for Sept. 16 stood at 58.4% on the Investing.com Fed Rate Monitor (CME-linked) as of 5:55a ET Tuesday, a touch below the 60-66% range multiple desks were quoting late last week — the trackers are not reconciled here.

BUSINESS

Amazon issued its formal rebuttal to the FTC's Aug. 31 suit over Sponsored Products auction pricing, disputing the agency's "misguided" characterization and its evidence of consumer harm. The company said advertisers saved more than \$8 billion from 2021-2025 as ad relevance improved, that average winning bids fell roughly 50% over that span, and that about 92% of ad placements did not go to the highest bidder — direct rebuttals to the FTC's core allegation that Amazon converted its nominally second-price auction into a de facto first-price one roughly 80% of the time since 2019. Nvidia's \$12.9-13B Hugging Face acquisition remains under US and EU regulatory review; Nvidia's Sept. 2 SEC filing confirms an approximately \$11.9B payment to shareholders plus roughly \$1B in retention equity, with close still expected in the first half of 2027. Options pricing ahead of Thursday's Adobe print implies roughly a 5.4% post-earnings move in either direction — a wide implied swing for a name whose own guidance already sits at the top of consensus, and a signal that positioning going in is more hedged than directional. Broadcom's Sept. 4 beat (Q3 revenue \$29.59B vs. ~\$29.44B consensus, EPS \$2.68) still drew an after-hours pullback

of roughly 3%, a "sell the news" reaction against elevated AI-capex expectations; no further movement reported since.

TECHNOLOGY

GPT-6 Astra's rollout widened further: OpenAI has now opened the model on its API and via AWS, in addition to the Pro/Enterprise/Business-Premium and Plus/Business Work-and-Codex tiers already live; broader ChatGPT web and app availability remains "in the coming days." API pricing is confirmed at \$10 per million input tokens and \$50 per million output tokens (\$1 cached input; batch/flex processing at half price; a Fast mode at 2x), with a 1.05M-token context window, 128K maximum output and an April 30, 2026 knowledge cutoff. The "critical cybersecurity threshold" tag under OpenAI's Preparedness Framework — first flagged in Issue No. 10 — specifically means the model can identify and develop functional zero-day exploits in hardened real-world systems without step-by-step human guidance; OpenAI says internal evaluation surfaced two previously unknown vulnerabilities, now under responsible disclosure to the affected maintainers, and the API build rejects a defined set of offensive-security prompts as a result. Anthropic had not released its IPO prospectus as of this run's press time, despite reporting pointing to an after-Labor-Day release; the company's June 1 confidential S-1 draft remains the only confirmed filing step. **[prospectus timing reported, not confirmed by the company]**

GEOPOLITICS

Israeli airstrikes on southern Lebanon killed at least 11 people, including two children and two medics, in strikes on Kfar Reman, Nabatieh and Arab Salim overnight Sunday into Monday — the most lethal single episode since the June ceasefire nominally halted Israel-Hezbollah fighting. In Ukraine, the Witkoff-Kushner shuttle-diplomacy truce frayed almost immediately: hours after Zelensky agreed to pause strikes on Moscow, Russia struck the Kyiv headquarters of Ukraine's Secret Service, and the Kremlin's Peskov said there was "no talk of new ideas" to end the war. Putin's three-day halt on Kyiv strikes and Zelensky's matching pause on Moscow strikes were both due to lapse this week; no confirmation was located this run of whether either side resumed strikes on schedule.

[not confirmed] Witkoff and Kushner's shuttle diplomacy produced no announced framework or timeline for follow-on talks, leaving the strike-on-capital pause — not a ceasefire, and never billed as one by either government — as the only concrete deliverable from the weekend's diplomacy.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the Aramco strike and Rezaei's exclusion-zone announcement (see Lead), Iran raised gasoline prices 100% for heavy consumers effective Tuesday, hitting roughly 15% of drivers as currency depreciation and domestic fuel shortages squeeze an economy that has been on a war footing for six months. Separately, Iran-Oman talks on managing Hormuz traffic have entered what officials describe as "final stages," alongside Iran's stated plan to publish maps for an alternative international shipping corridor

through the strait — the clearest sign yet that Tehran is working toward a permission-based transit regime rather than a blanket closure. CBS reports the US military has redirected 94 commercial vessels found to be in violation of the US Navy's own blockade line since the crisis began; that figure is single-sourced to CBS's live coverage and was not corroborated by any CENTCOM statement reviewed this run. **[single-sourced]** The dark-tanker and transit figures on the Board reflect straits.live's latest 24-hour measurement window and should not be read against the ">80% of traffic" figure carried in prior issues, which used a different period and methodology. On the insurance side, the standing backstop remains the US International Development Finance Corporation's roughly \$20B war-risk reinsurance facility, launched in March alongside the International Group of P&I Clubs' formal withdrawal of Gulf war-risk cover — the facility, not a return of private cover, is what is keeping the ~\$10M/VLCC premium finite rather than effectively infinite.

SPORTS

Yankees	off Monday; open a 3-game home series vs. the Rockies tonight, 7:05p ET. 81-61, 3.5 back of Tampa Bay (84-57) in the AL East; hold the top AL wild card
Knicks	Josh Hart extension still unsigned; no new terms reported since 9/3
Northwestern	on a bye at 1-0; next game Sat. 9/19 vs. Colorado

Continuity. Dropped as resolved/unchanged since 9/7: Waller's Thursday dovish remarks (superseded by Friday's jobs report, covered in Issue No. 11); the Sept. 6 OPEC+ quota hold (resolved, no further movement). Watching: whether Brent holds above \$95 into Thursday's Adobe earnings and Friday's CPI; confirmation or lapse of the Kyiv/Moscow strike pauses; Anthropic's still-pending IPO prospectus; further GPT-6 Astra rollout to ChatGPT web/app; the Yankees-Rockies series and any Josh Hart extension movement; CENTCOM confirmation or denial of the 94-vessel-redirect figure and of Rezaei's "new missiles" claim.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.